

Yongyi Lin

Ph.D. Candidate, Managerial Economics
University of Maryland
College Park, MD 20742

Personal Website
ylin17@umd.edu
+1 (240) 726-2453

RESEARCH EXPERTISE

My research examines how institutional rules and market structures shape firms' innovation strategies when appropriability over knowledge is fragile. Using quasi-experimental methods, I study how transparency mandates, intellectual property regimes, and venture capital concentration affect R&D portfolio decisions: geographic allocation, project selection, and the choice between novel and incremental innovation. Related projects on disclosure spillovers to rivals and market power in entrepreneurial finance speak to competitive strategy and how organizations adapt innovation effort under institutional constraints.

EDUCATION

University of Maryland, College Park 2021 – 2027 (expected)

Ph.D., Managerial Economics

Dissertation: Forces Shaping Innovation: Disclosure, Market Structure, and Firm R&D

Award: Clifton T. and Jane Story Phillips Scholarship

Duke University 2019 – 2021

M.A., Economics

Award: M.A. Merit Scholarship

Jinan University 2015 – 2019

B.A., Economics

Award: Outstanding Undergraduate Scholarship

WORKING PAPERS

Disclosure, Appropriability, and R&D Portfolio Choice: Evidence from the Pharmaceutical Industry

Job Market Paper | Under review, *Management Science* | Draft

Nominated for the 2025 Strategic Management Society Ph.D. Paper Prize

Abstract:

R&D produces knowledge that patents leave unprotected, and firms appropriate its returns only by keeping it confidential. I ask whether firms that anticipate losing appropriability over this unpatented knowledge reshape their R&D portfolios. The FDA Amendments Act of 2007 mandated public reporting of clinical-trial results. Difference-in-differences estimates show that firms with larger pre-policy U.S. portfolio shares redirect new projects from the U.S. to other markets and discontinue more of their U.S.-targeted projects. Among the U.S.-targeted projects they still start, they shift toward less novel chemistry and, except at the largest firms, away from biologics and new technologies. These adjustments emerge at preclinical entry, before the trial phases the Act covers, suggesting that firms respond to anticipated rather than realized disclosure. Disclosure therefore shapes not only who can access knowledge once it exists, but which knowledge firms choose to create.

Venture Capital, Market Structure, and the Financing of Innovation

with Chengmou Lei | Poster, 2026 American Finance Association Annual Meeting

Are There Gender Differences in Ambition? Evidence from an Online Experiment

with Nathan Barrymore and Cristian L. Dezső

SELECTED WORKS IN PROGRESS

Information Transparency and Brain Drain

Signaling and Venture Capital Investment Decisions

PUBLICATIONS

Has Urbanization Accelerated PM_{2.5} Emissions? An Empirical Analysis with Cross-Country Data
with Qichen Dong, Jieyu Huang, and Zhongfei Chen | *China Economic Review*, 2020 | Pre-doctoral research

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

UNIVERSITY OF MARYLAND, COLLEGE PARK

BMGT392 – International Business (Instructor) Spring 2025, 2026

BUSO626 – Global Economic Environment (TA) Spring 2024

BUSI758 – Global Risks and Opportunities (TA) Spring 2022

BUSI788 – Global Business (TA) Fall 2021, 2022, 2023

DUKE UNIVERSITY

ECON601 – Microeconomic Theory (TA) Fall 2020

CONFERENCES AND PRESENTATIONS

American Economic Association Annual Meeting 2026

American Finance Association Annual Meeting 2026

Wharton Corporate Strategy and Innovation Conference 2025

Academy of Management Annual Meeting 2025

Strategy Science Conference 2025

Industry Studies Association Annual Meeting 2025

Duke Strategy Ph.D. Conference 2025

East Coast Doctoral Conference 2025

METHODS AND TOOLS

Languages and tools: Python, Stata, R, SQL, LaTeX, Git, Microsoft Office

Causal and statistical methods: Difference-in-differences, event study, fixed effects, matching and inverse-probability weighting, semiparametric and double/debiased ML, survival analysis, experimental design

Machine learning and data: Deep learning (LSTM/RNN), gradient boosting, time-series forecasting, clustering and similarity analysis, record linkage and fuzzy matching

REFERENCES

Cristian L. Dezső

Professor
University of Maryland
cdezso@umd.edu
+1 (301) 405-7832

Evan P. Starr

Professor
University of Maryland
estarr@umd.edu
+1 (301) 405-1054

Rachelle C. Sampson

Associate Professor
University of Maryland
sampsonr@umd.edu
+1 (301) 405-7658

Ginger Jin

Allen and Kelli Questrom Professor
Boston University
gzjin@bu.edu
+1 (617) 353-4408

Wilbur Chung

Associate Professor
University of Maryland
wchung@umd.edu
+1 (301) 405-8967